WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

PERU

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Lima–Callao	Capital and commercial heart of the country; Callao hosts the principal container port and the main international airport	Financial services, retail, logistics, real estate
Chancay (north of Lima)	Cosco Shipping-operated deep-water port with direct Asia services; container throughput reached 200,000 TEU in H1 2026, up 71% year-on-year	Port logistics, industrial parks, trans-Pacific trade
Arequipa–Moquegua (south)	Core of the southern copper belt, where Southern Copper's $1.8 billion Tía María project (120,000 tonnes a year) is targeting production in 2027	Copper mining, mining services, power
Apurímac–Cusco corridor	Major copper district, including the planned $2.6 billion Los Chancas project, and home to the Camisea natural gas fields	Copper, natural gas, tourism
Cajamarca and the northern highlands	Gold and copper region where the $2.5 billion Michiquillay project is planned to produce 225,000 tonnes of copper a year	Mining, mining services, agriculture
Northern coastal valleys (La Libertad, Lambayeque, Piura)	Irrigated export-agriculture heartland supporting an agricultural export sector that grew 18.5% in 2025	Agro-exports, food processing, cold-chain logistics
Special Development Zones (Paita, Ilo, Matarani, Tacna)	Established zones near ports and the Chilean border, now complemented by a private special economic zone regime whose regulation was approved in April 2026	Export processing, light manufacturing, logistics

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- ProInversión (private investment promotion agency) manages public-private partnerships and asset projects, with a portfolio of around $40 billion across 86 projects and $2.5 billion awarded in January–July 2026
- Legal stability agreements under Legislative Decrees 662 and 757, signed with ProInversión, which lock in the tax and legal regime applicable to qualifying investments
- Public-private partnership (APP) framework and the Works-for-Taxes (Obras por Impuestos) scheme, which set a record in 2024 with more than $1 billion of projects awarded

- Private Special Economic Zones regime, with its regulation approved on 22 April 2026, offering tax and customs incentives and legal stability, alongside the existing Special Development Zones at Paita, Ilo, Matarani and Tacna
- Central Reserve Bank of Peru (BCRP) oversight of a free-floating sol, with national treatment for foreign investors and no restrictions on capital movements or profit repatriation
- Mining concessions and permits through the Ministry of Energy and Mines, which reports a mining project portfolio of more than $64 billion and mining investment of around $6.3 billion in 2026
- PromPerú trade and investment promotion, which secured $2.5 billion in foreign direct investment commitments in 2025 and targets food, tourism, manufacturing, knowledge services and renewable energy

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Peru in October 2026 combines one of Latin America's strongest macroeconomic foundations with a new government focused on growth and productivity. GDP expanded 3.4% in 2025, and the central bank projects 3.2% growth in 2026, led by non-primary sectors growing 4.7% and capital-goods imports up nearly 27% in Q2. Exports reached a record $90.1 billion in 2025, up 21%, delivering a trade surplus of $43 billion over the twelve months to April 2026 and lifting international reserves above $100 billion for the first time, equivalent to 28% of GDP. Public debt of around 30% of GDP and a fiscal deficit targeted to fall from 2.2% of GDP in 2025 to 1.8% in 2026 underpin its investment-grade standing. Peru accounted for 6% of Latin America's FDI in 2025 and holds a registered FDI stock of $34.2 billion. President Keiko Fujimori, inaugurated on 28 July 2026, appointed former central bank director Elmer Cuba as Economy Minister, with priorities of productivity, job creation and tackling tax evasion.

Peru's defining structural feature is the contrast between frequent political turnover, with nine presidents in a decade, and remarkable macroeconomic continuity. An autonomous central bank, fiscal rules and long-standing legal stability agreements have kept policy predictable across administrations, and Moody's has noted that Peru retains greater credibility than peers with similar ratings. The economy is currently navigating a strong coastal El Niño: sea temperatures were about 4.6°C above normal in September, anchovy and fishmeal output fell 73% in January–July, and BBVA Research estimates an impact of 0.9 points on 2026 growth and 1.3 points in 2027. Mitigation is under way, with the government reporting 60% of prevention works complete, and the event is strengthening the case for investment in water, irrigation, flood defence and resilient infrastructure. Inflation of 4.5% in September is above the 1–3% target range, and the central bank, holding its rate at 4.25%, has signalled readiness to act.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Political turnover	Peru has had nine presidents in a decade and the June 2026 runoff was decided by fewer than 50,000 votes, which can slow policy delivery	An autonomous central bank, fiscal rules and legal stability agreements provide continuity; structure projects under these protections and the US–Peru Trade Promotion Agreement where applicable
Social licence in mining regions	Land-access and community conflicts have at times delayed major mining projects and moderated investor confidence	Early community engagement, local hiring and benefit-sharing through mining royalties and canon transfers support project delivery, as shown by local employment at Tía María
Informal and illegal mining	Informal gold mining is widespread and the government has proposed a new system to formalise around 30,000 miners	Apply rigorous supply-chain due diligence and partner with formal operators; formalisation creates opportunities in traceability, processing and mining services
Coastal El Niño 2026	Unusually warm seas have reduced fishmeal output and are expected to weigh on growth into early 2027, especially in the north	Build climate resilience and insurance into project design; prevention and reconstruction programmes create demand for water, flood-defence and infrastructure investment
Inflation above target	Inflation reached 4.5% in September 2026, above the 1–3% target range, with	Reserves above $100 billion and a credible central bank anchor the sol; apply

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	the policy rate held at 4.25%	standard hedging for local-currency exposure
Regulatory complexity and permitting	Regulatory hurdles, customs processes and tax administration are cited as obstacles to faster project execution	Engage ProInversión's APP 5.0 process and experienced local counsel; legal stability agreements reduce exposure to regulatory change
Infrastructure gap	Peru's national infrastructure plan identified 72 priority projects worth nearly $39 billion to close long-standing gaps	Treat the gap as an investment pipeline through PPPs, Works-for-Taxes and port and logistics projects linked to Chancay and Callao

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Peru's risk profile reflects an economy with exceptional macroeconomic buffers and a long track record of policy continuity through political change. Reserves above $100 billion, public debt of around 30% of GDP, a fiscal deficit on a declining path and record exports provide substantial resilience, and Moody's has highlighted Peru's credibility relative to similarly rated peers. Political turnover is the principal consideration, but the new administration's appointment of a former central bank director as Economy Minister and its focus on productivity and investment are encouraging signals. Community relations in mining regions and informal mining require careful management, which experienced operators address through early engagement, local benefit-sharing and robust due diligence. The 2026 coastal El Niño is a temporary but material factor for fishing, northern agriculture and logistics into early 2027; investors should build climate scenarios into planning while recognising the opportunities created by prevention and reconstruction spending.

MARKET ACCESS

Peru has been a WTO member since 1995 and is among the most open economies in Latin America, with free trade agreements covering its principal markets, including the US–Peru Trade Promotion Agreement, an FTA with China, a trade agreement with the EU (and a parallel agreement with the UK), and membership of the CPTPP, the Pacific Alliance, the Andean Community and APEC. China is the leading export destination, taking 36.2% of exports in 2025, with the United States and the European Union also major markets. Exports are anchored by copper, gold and other minerals, which grew 25.9% in 2025, alongside a fast-growing agro-export sector. The Chancay port, with direct services to Chinese ports, and the established hub at Callao give Peru a strong position as a Pacific gateway between South America and Asia.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Keiko Fujimori) and Presidency of the Council of Ministers (Luis Galarreta)	Sets national policy priorities, including growth, security and political stability, following the July 2026 transition	Primary reference point for understanding the new administration's strategic direction
ProInversión	National agency for private investment, managing a PPP and asset portfolio of around $40 billion and legal stability agreements	Standard first point of contact for infrastructure, PPP and stability-agreement matters
Ministry of Economy and Finance (Elmer Cuba)	Leads fiscal policy, the fiscal rule and the investment framework, with priorities of productivity, jobs and tax compliance	Key interlocutor on fiscal incentives, tax policy and the PPP framework
Central Reserve Bank of Peru (BCRP)	Autonomous monetary authority managing the free-floating sol and over $100 billion in reserves	Relevant for currency, banking and macroeconomic outlook
Ministry of Energy and Mines	Regulates mining and hydrocarbons, overseeing a mining portfolio of more than $64 billion	Essential counterpart for mining, energy and permitting

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Ministry of Foreign Trade and Tourism (Mincetur)	Negotiates trade agreements and leads the new Private Special Economic Zones regime	Relevant for trade access, zone incentives and tourism investment
PromPerú	Promotes exports, tourism and foreign direct investment, with priority sectors identified for 2026	Useful channel for sector intelligence and investor introductions

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce of Peru (AmCham Peru), the Lima Chamber of Commerce and the Peruvian-British Chamber of Commerce are the leading channels for international business, alongside the national business confederation CONFIEP. Sector bodies such as the National Society of Mining, Petroleum and Energy (SNMPE), the National Society of Industries (SNI) and the exporters' association ADEX provide practical intelligence and policy access. ProInversión and PromPerú run regular investor events and roadshows, and the biennial PERUMIN mining convention in Arequipa is a key meeting point for the mining sector. The World Bank, IFC, Inter-American Development Bank and CAF – Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean maintain active programmes supporting infrastructure, climate resilience and private-sector development.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Peru suits investors seeking exposure to a well-managed, resource-rich economy with a strong Pacific trade orientation: mining and mining-services investors drawn by a project portfolio of more than $64 billion and a world-class copper endowment; infrastructure and PPP investors able to engage with ProInversión's $40 billion pipeline; logistics and manufacturing investors positioning around Chancay, Callao and the new private special economic zones; and agribusiness and food-processing investors building on record agricultural exports. Financial investors benefit from deep reserves and a credible central bank, while all investors should apply careful community-engagement and climate-resilience planning.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage ProInversión and assess the project pipeline
Open dialogue with ProInversión on PPP and asset projects, and explore a legal stability agreement for qualifying investments.

STEP 2: Establish early contact with the new economic team
Brief the Ministry of Economy and Finance and the relevant sector ministries on investment plans as the Fujimori administration sets its priorities.

STEP 3: Evaluate private special economic zone and port-linked opportunities
Assess incentives under the new private SEZ regime and logistics positioning around Chancay, Callao and the southern ports.

STEP 4: Build community engagement into project planning
For mining and infrastructure projects, design early, transparent engagement and local benefit-sharing from the outset.

STEP 5: Factor climate resilience into investment decisions
Incorporate El Niño scenarios into planning and consider opportunities in water, irrigation and resilient infrastructure linked to prevention and reconstruction programmes.